



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Ireland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's great — being fluent in Danish and having an international background gives you a strong foundation and some flexibility. Since you're 16 and have just finished **primary school** in Denmark (which likely means **9th or 10th grade** of *folkeskole*, depending on your route), you're at a key decision point. In Denmark, you now typically choose between several types of **youth education** (*ungdomsuddannelse*), depending on your interests, academic level, and future plans.

Here are the main paths you can consider, and some recommendations based on your background:

🎓 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Academic Upper Secondary Education)

These are great if you're aiming for university or want to keep your options open.

a) STX (Almen Studentereksamen)

- Broad academic focus: humanities, social sciences, and natural sciences.
- Good if you enjoy general academic subjects and want flexibility.
- Duration: 3 years.

b) HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)

- Focus on business, economics, marketing, and languages.
- Good for those interested in entrepreneurship, business, or international work.
- Duration: 3 years.

c) HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)

- Focus on technology, IT, math, and science.
- Ideal if you're curious about engineering, science, or tech.
- Duration: 3 years.

d) IB (International Baccalaureate)

- Taught in English, with an international focus.
- Excellent if you might study or work abroad, especially in English-speaking countries like Ireland.
- Available at select schools in Denmark.
- Duration: 2 years (+ 1 pre-IB year often required).

💡 **Recommended if:** You enjoy academic subjects, want to go to university later, and aren't yet sure exactly what field you'll choose. With your Irish background and native-level English, the **IB** could be a particularly smart option — it's globally recognized.

🔧 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training – VET)

More hands-on, career-focused programs. You learn a trade or profession and spend time both in school and as an apprentice.

Examples include:

- Electrician
- Carpenter
- Chef
- Hairdresser
- IT Supporter
- Healthcare Assistant

Duration: 2-5 years, depending on the field and prior education.

💡 **Recommended if:** You prefer practical learning and want to start working earlier. You can always continue your education later, and Denmark supports lifelong learning.

👜 3. EUX – A Hybrid Option

This combines vocational training with academic subjects — you get both a VET qualification and a high school diploma (like STX or HHX).

💡 **Recommended if:** You want a trade but also want the option to go to university later. It's challenging but flexible.

🎯 How to Choose?

Ask yourself:

- Do you enjoy academic work, or prefer hands-on learning?
 - Are you interested in going to university?
 - Do you want to work right after school or keep studying?
 - Are you more interested in science, business, arts, technology, or practical trades?
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📌 My General Recommendation for You:

Since you're fluent in Danish and have an Irish background, you're in a unique position to thrive in both Danish and international environments.

If you're academically inclined or unsure, I'd recommend:

- **STX** or **IB**, depending on how international you want your path to be.
- If you're interested in business or working abroad in the future: **HHX** or **IB** would be excellent.

If you prefer practical work or a faster path to a job:

- Consider a **VET program** or **EUX** in a field that genuinely interests you (IT, healthcare, trades, etc.).

Would you like help finding schools or programs in your area, or would you like to do a short quiz to match your interests with a Danish youth education path?